

BOOSTCAMP: Welcome to Entrepreneurship!

The first two weeks of the program will be your own challenge!

What does entrepreneurship mean to you? Being an entrepreneur means **initiating and managing** a business venture or startup. Entrepreneurs are individuals who take **innovative ideas** and transform them into practical, successful, profitable businesses. They often exhibit traits such as **creativity, risk-taking, and resilience**. Entrepreneurs identify opportunities, create business plans, secure funding, build teams, and navigate challenges to bring their vision to life. Whether it's launching a tech startup, opening a small café, or developing a new product, entrepreneurship involves a combination of vision, determination, and adaptability.

It's often said that the only way to learn entrepreneurship is to learn by doing:

Getting out there, talking to people and learning from the feedback you receive. That's what we will be doing during the Boost Camp Challenge.

Do you remember making your first money as a child? Cleaning cars, collecting empty bottles or mowing the lawn of your neighbors? Simple but effective!

These two weeks you will be working in teams of (approx.) 5 students to come up with and execute a business idea to show and practice your entrepreneurial skills. What can you come up with?

The Entrepreneurial Challenge

Week 1: Opportunity recognition & doing

Objective: *Devise, develop and pitch a business case within just 4 days.*

1. **Brainstorming Session:** Work in teams to generate creative ideas for a new product, service, or concept.
2. **Market Research:** Research the market to determine if there's demand for their idea and identify potential customers.
3. **Get out of the building:** Get out of the building and see what happens, can your team make some money or success?
4. **Pitch 1:** are you successful?

Week 2: Apply knowledge & Present viable Business Case

Objective: *Turn your simple idea into a business. Present a Lean canvas.*

1. **Business Model:** *Learn* about different business models and *apply* them to your idea.
2. **Marketing:** *Develop* a simple marketing plan. *Validate* your idea by interviewing potential customers and gathering feedback.
3. **Finance:** *Create* a simple financial projection (revenue, costs, profit) for your idea.
4. **Research:** *Investigate* your customer and the success of your business.
5. **Ethics:** *Consider* Ethical aspects when it comes to your business.

Pitch: *Present* your idea(s), adjustments and success to a jury of lecturers, entrepreneurs, or experts.

So: together with your team you come up with and execute a business idea and gain practical experience in entrepreneurship, market research, and business development. You will experience how to act swiftly and turn creativity into profitable and successful opportunities.

Deliverables:

Check-in & out vlogs (Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday week 1)

- Show the date in a creative manner
- Check-in: share your plan for the day (before 09:30)
- Check-out: share your progress and achievements (send between 16:00-16:30)
- End of week 1 Lean Canvas version 1

Details:

6 videos (min 30 seconds, max 2 minutes)

All team members must be visible in the video

Share your videos via WhatsApp (BoB Boostcamp), indicate your team number for easy access for peers.

Feedback to Vlogs of other Teams

- Per team: provide positive and constructive feedback to one of the other teams:
 - o Check out the who-provides-feedback-to-whom on Brightspace
 - o Indicate things you really like about the business or approach of that team
 - o Provide tips for the team to help them become more successful
 - o Send a personal reply to the team (text, audio or video) via WhatsApp

Pitch 1 – Friday week 1

- Limited to 5 minutes per team
- You explain your idea and what you have done
- Present your Lean canvas version 1
- You show what you have achieved
- You reflect on your degree of successfulness based on your success criteria
- You demonstrate points of improvement
- You evaluate on the teamwork and how this relates to each other's qualities

Pitch Deck & Presentation: Thursday week 2

- Limited to 5 minutes per team
- Present your Pitch deck and Lean canvas version 2. **At least two building blocks of the Lean canvas in week 2 should be significantly changed in comparison to your earlier versions.** Use the knowledge presented to you in workshops from week 2.
- You explain the alterations you made based on research & solution interviews
 - o Trend analysis
 - o Market potential and target group
- You evaluate the process and alternations
 - o Evaluate creative tools & techniques

- Demonstrate to have tested alternatives and implementation of the changes
- You share your main take aways & key learnings

Details:

Pitch Deck: Upload your Pitch Deck on Brightspace ('Boostcamp – Pitch Deck') before Friday week 2 12:00 (=noon, not midnight)

You can upload Supportive materials. This may include:

- Context analysis (market potential, trend analysis)
- Customer research and validation: proof of your solution interviews
- Business model canvas / value proposition
- Idea generation and selection process / reflection the process

The following may help you get an idea how investors (or Boostcamp Lecturers) look at a Pitch Deck:

1. Business Description:
 - How well is the business concept explained?
 - Is the new concept reasonable, sustainable, and scalable?
2. Market Analysis:
 - Characteristics of the market and customer description ○ Is there genuine demand for the product or service?
 - How well-defined is the target market, and what's its size and growth?
3. Product or Service Analysis:
 - Clarity of the product or service description ○ Feasibility and potential for duplication ○ Presence of substitutes
4. Competition:
 - Identification of current and potential competitors
 - Strengths and weaknesses analysis
5. Marketing Strategy:
 - Realistic marketing plan (price, product, place, promotion)
 - Adequate resource allocation for marketing
6. Operations:
 - Likelihood of securing required production resources
 - Ability to operate competitively and grow
7. Management:
 - Assessment of the entrepreneur(s) and team
 - Depth and breadth of team capabilities
8. Finances:
 - Compelling business model ○ Addressing required resources ○ Reasonable financial projections
9. Presentation:
 - Engaging pitch, confident delivery ○ Clear visual aids (e.g., PowerPoint® slides)

Note: also check out the grading criteria in the Rubric!